

Option 4: The World of Cultural Diversity

Option 5: Pollution and Human Health at Risk

Option 6: Consuming the Rural Landscape – Leisure and Tourism.

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**Students research  
one option**

Students must select and study **one** research option from the above list that reflects their geographical interests.

Options in this unit range from those with a strong physical geography focus, to those concerned more with environmental, social and cultural geographies.

The options are designed to expose students to a range of geographical information in a variety of forms, namely books, journals, video and the internet. Many of these will be unfamiliar in terms of context and content. Part of this holistic exploration will involve linking content and concepts from Units 1, 2 and 3 into students' research.

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**Global synoptic  
contexts**

The global synoptic context sets each option within a wider context to encourage synoptic links both within this unit, and Unit 3. Each of the six research options promote in-depth research of a key area of geography. Before embarking on detailed research, students should briefly investigate their chosen topic using the global synoptic context as a guide. Teachers may allow students to explore a number of global synoptic contexts before students make their final decision about which research option to select. There are three broad initial questions which students should explore. Teachers may wish to use group work, presentations and other active learning strategies within teaching groups to allow students to share their initial research and ideas.

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## Fieldwork

Fieldwork is an important component of research and centres should provide, where possible, fieldwork opportunities for students to enhance their understanding and experience. There is scope for extensive use of virtual fieldwork and GIS.

Suggested fieldwork opportunities are highlighted at the end of each research option.

## 4.2 Assessment information

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### Time

1 hour and 30 minute examination including pre-released research focus material.

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### Materials

Research focus material for each option will be pre-released as advance information **four** working weeks before the examination via the Edexcel website ([www.edexcel.org.uk](http://www.edexcel.org.uk)).

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### Questions and marks

Students will be given a list of questions based on the **six** options. Students will select and answer **one** question that relates to the option they have studied. They will be required to write a long essay, in which they demonstrate and synthesise the results of their research.

Each question is out of 70 marks.

Students will **not** be able to take any pre-released or research materials into the examination.